Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Santé et numérique : Onze projets pour accélérer la transformation du système sanitaire** — La Gazette des Comores, 30 October 2026 COMOROS

  Comoros's health statistics directorate said on 27 October 2026 that only one of eleven projects in the 2022 digital health plan has been substantially implemented. It cited lack of funds. DHIS2 is in use with an electronic vaccination register, and malaria forecasting is being piloted in five Ngazidja districts. *Also under Sectoral management information systems.*

- **From Digital Strategies to Delivery: AU Ministers Call for Increased Investment and Faster Implementation** — African Union Commission, 30 October 2026 GABON AFRICA

  The African Union's ICT ministerial committee opened its sixth session in Libreville on 29 October 2026, with Ghana taking the chair from Lesotho. AU Commissioner Lerato Mataboge asked ministers for financing and implementation, not new strategies. She called for investment in cross-border fibre, data centres and internet exchange points. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **ECOWAS E-Commerce Forum Advances Regional Action to Expand Digital Trade and Inclusive Market Access** — ECOWAS Commission, 30 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

  The ECOWAS Commission and the West African Regional Digital Integration Project held an e-commerce forum in Abuja on 27 and 28 October 2026. It worked on implementing the ECOWAS E-Commerce Strategy 2023–2027 and a draft action plan. The plan covers women, young people, people with disabilities and small cross-border traders. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

Data protection

- **Protection des données : Seules 23 000 entreprises enregistrées sur 60 000** — L'Express (Maurice), 30 October 2026 MAURITIUS

  Mauritius launched a guide on data protection in the financial sector on 29 October 2026. The ICT minister said about 23,000 of some 60,000 entities required to register under the Data Protection Act 2017 had done so. He announced training for data protection officers and a review of the Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act 2021. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Cybersecurity.*

- **GCIS warns of information breach** — ITWeb South Africa, 30 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's GCIS told applicants that its e-recruitment system had been compromised, possibly exposing ID numbers, phone numbers and e-mail addresses. Suspicious activity on its web systems was identified on 24 October 2026. GCIS reported the incident to the Information Regulator, the police and the State Security Agency. *Also under Cybersecurity*.

Regional collaboration

- **UbuntuNet Connect 2026: Shaping Digital Horizons** — European Union Delegation to Malawi, 30 October 2026 MALAWI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  The EU took part in UbuntuNet Connect 2026 in Lilongwe on 29 and 30 October, marking the UbuntuNet Alliance's 20th year. The EU says AfricaConnect has connected over 3,000 institutions and reached over 9 million students and researchers. It also funds Malawi work on digital identity, governance, skills and ICT regulation. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **ECO currency expected to replace national currencies, Finance Minister says** — Foroyaa Newspaper, 30 October 2026 GAMBIA

  The Gambia's finance minister told the National Assembly on 28 October 2026 that the central bank has committed to implementing PAPSS. He said the bank is integrating the country's payment systems with it. He also said The Gambia should meet three of the four ECOWAS convergence criteria in 2026 and all four in 2027. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech*.

- **EAC states pursue unified AI strategy** — ITWeb Africa, 30 October 2026 EAST AFRICA

  The 21st EAC Sectoral Council on Education, Science, Technology, Culture and Sports, meeting in Uganda, took up the draft EAC AI Strategy. The strategy has been through national consultations in all partner states and a regional validation in Kampala in 2026. No council decision on it has been reported. *Also under AI*.

- **AfricaNenda's Sabine F. Mensah: "Regulatory Fragmentation Remains One of the Most Difficult Challenges to Navigate"** — Business in Cameroon, 30 October 2026 AFRICA

  AfricaNenda deputy CEO Sabine F. Mensah told Business in Cameroon that differing identity, compliance and licensing rules slow cross-border payments in Africa. She called for an African Union framework and licence passporting for fintechs. AfricaNenda's SIIPS 2026 report is due on 19 November 2026. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech*.

- **Accra Welcomes the Second Cohort of the COYWA Programme to Strengthen the Digital and Financial Skills of Young People and Women Entrepreneurs** — ECOWAS Commission, 30 October 2026 GHANA WEST AFRICA

  ECOWAS, AUDA-NEPAD and the Spanish development agency AECID held the second COYWA training session in Accra from 26 to 30 October 2026. Young and women entrepreneurs were trained in digital tools, online security, financial skills and the use of AI. The session followed an online phase that began on 23 September. *Also under Training and skills*.

- **From Digital Strategies to Delivery: AU Ministers Call for Increased Investment and Faster Implementation** — African Union Commission, 30 October 2026 GABON AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **ECOWAS E-Commerce Forum Advances Regional Action to Expand Digital Trade and Inclusive Market Access** — ECOWAS Commission, 30 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Standards

- **AI is transforming our future – but who will benefit?** — International Telecommunication Union (ITU), 30 October 2026 GLOBAL

  ITU Deputy Secretary-General Tomas Lamanauskas wrote on 30 October 2026 on who gains from AI investment, drawing on his World Investment Forum remarks. He cited World Bank figures giving Latin America and Africa 3.3% of data-centre capacity. He said ITU, UNCTAD and eight development banks had launched a Digital Infrastructure Investment Catalyser. *Also under AI and Technical Capacity.*

- **Africa seeks control of AI safety as Eswatini launches standards centre** — The Standard, 30 October 2026 ESWATINI

  The Eswatini Standards Authority and AICE Africa launched an AI Safety and Standards Centre of Excellence on 27 October 2026. It will train standards officers, auditors and regulators, and work towards an AI testing laboratory and an African AI standards baseline report. An AI safety summit is planned for Mbabane in July 2027. *Also under AI and Training and skills.*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **AI exacerbates election disinformation, say experts** — ITWeb South Africa, 30 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  The CSIR and GCIS held an online media roundtable on AI and elections in the week of 26 October 2026, ahead of South Africa's municipal elections. A Centre for Analytics and Behavioural Change researcher said its monitoring had found AI-generated videos, including one of Nelson Mandela. The CSIR asked partners to join a network against misinformation. *Also under AI.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Workonline Communications Brings Its African Network To IXAfrica's NBOX1 Campus In Nairobi** — Data Centres Africa, 30 October 2026 KENYA

  Workonline Communications opened a point of presence at iXAfrica's NBOX1 data-centre campus in Nairobi, reported on 30 October 2026. It offers IP transit, Ethernet and remote peering to networks in the facility. The company already had a presence in Nairobi and Mombasa. *Also under Data Storage.*

- **Kenya Rolls Out 30,000 Kilometres of Fibre Infrastructure Since 2022** — Tech Africa News, 30 October 2026 KENYA

  ICT Principal Secretary John Tanui said Kenya has laid more than 30,000 km of fibre since 2022. He spoke at the second national-county ICT consultative forum in Naivasha. The forum took up a proposed County Digital Maturity Index, the National AI Agenda and the draft National DPI Roadmap. *Also under Digitalisation of sub-national government.*

- **Airtel Uganda Adds 840 Sites in Two Years, Takes Network to the Skies With Starlink** — TechAfrica News, 30 October 2026 UGANDA

  Airtel Uganda's managing director, Soumendra Sahu, said the company has built 840 new sites in two years, enlarging its network by about 25%. Starlink's direct-to-phone service went live through Airtel in September 2026. Sahu put smartphone penetration at 42–43% and asked for duty and VAT relief on low-cost phones. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **UbuntuNet Connect 2026: Shaping Digital Horizons** — European Union Delegation to Malawi, 30 October 2026 MALAWI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

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Data Storage

- **Workonline Communications Brings Its African Network To IXAfrica's NBOX1 Campus In Nairobi** — Data Centres Africa, 30 October 2026 KENYA

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Technical Capacity

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  Summarised under Standards.

Cybersecurity

- **Cameroon warns of rising fintech cyberthreats** — ITWeb Africa, 30 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Cameroon's ICT agency ANTIC said it has audited 108 fintech companies and found 3,914 vulnerabilities. Its director-general spoke at the Digitize Cameroon forum in Mbankomo, which opened on 28 October 2026. Since an April 2025 ministry decision, platforms need ANTIC-verified security compliance to reach the national aggregation platform. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Cameroon Brings Together 100 Fintech Firms to Strengthen Digital Security** — Tech Africa News, 30 October 2026 CAMEROON

  About 100 fintech firms met in Mbankomo for a three-day forum on security and regulation, opened on 28 October 2026 by ANTIC's director-general. The forum is part of Digitise Cameroon 2026, run by ANTIC and The Change Engine. Digital payment services earned over FCFA 1,022 billion in 2024, 3.16% of GDP. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

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DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Éducation nationale : le numérique pour mieux gérer les agents de l'État** — Le N'Djam Post, 30 October 2026 CHAD

  Chad's education ministry gave biometric staff cards to academy rectors on 30 October 2026. It ordered its HR directorate to have the Mirador staff-management platform running by the end of November 2026. Personnel acts are to require the card, and deceased, retired and absent staff are to be removed from the active list. *Also under Sectoral management information systems.*

- **Thales, Cyshield join forces on Egypt's biometric border and passport plans** — Biometric Update, 30 October 2026 EGYPT

  Thales and the Egyptian firm Cyshield signed a memorandum on biometric border management and electronic passports for Egypt, reported on 30 October 2026. It covers biometric e-gates across more than 32 air, land and sea border points. It also covers issuance systems for a planned national e-passport rollout.

- **NIA arrests 6, sacks 7 others over extortion at Galaka Ghana Card Registration Centre** — Graphic Online, 30 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's National Identification Authority arrested six staff and dismissed seven over alleged extortion of parents at the Galaka Ghana Card centre in the Upper East Region. The demands were made during the free registration of children aged 6 to 14. The seven dismissed had known of them and not reported them.

- **Le Sénégal se dote d'un hub pour transformer les projets d'IA en applications concrètes** — wearetech.africa, 30 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Senegal and the Gates Foundation launched the Senegal AI Scaling Hub in Dakar on 29 October 2026. It is to take AI pilots into use in health, agriculture and education. The hub implements a September 2025 agreement worth over USD 10 million, which also covers digital identity and a delivery unit. *Also under AI.*

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Digital Payments and Fintech

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- **AfricaNenda's Sabine F. Mensah: "Regulatory Fragmentation Remains One of the Most Difficult Challenges to Navigate"** — Business in Cameroon, 30 October 2026 AFRICA

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Registries

- **INEC blames registration officers for AI-generated photos in voters' register** — Vanguard, 30 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's electoral commission said some registration officers used their own logins to add suspected AI-generated photos to the preliminary voters' register. Its biometric identification system found the records. ICT director Lawrence Bayode said the register, uploaded on 26 October 2026, is being cleaned within the 90-day statutory period. *Also under AI.*

Sectoral management information systems

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  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **Santé et numérique : Onze projets pour accélérer la transformation du système sanitaire** — La Gazette des Comores, 30 October 2026 COMOROS

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Senegal and Brazil strengthen digital cooperation to advance public service transformation** — Tech Review Africa, 30 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Senegal's digital minister, Samba Diouf, met Brazil's ambassador, Daniella Xavier Cesar, on 26 October 2026. They discussed Brazil's experience digitising public services and skills transfer under Senegal's New Deal Technologique. Brazil's part in the next Dakar International Fair was also discussed.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

- **Kenya Rolls Out 30,000 Kilometres of Fibre Infrastructure Since 2022** — Tech Africa News, 30 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Technology

AI

- **Zambia Partners With Huawei for AI Training Programme for Government Officials** — Tech Africa News, 30 October 2026 ZAMBIA

  SMART Zambia Institute and Huawei announced a five-day AI training programme for government officials, opening on 2 November 2026. Huawei will provide it free, with trainers from China. It covers national AI strategy, large language models, AI data centres and AI agents. *Also under Training and skills and China activities.*

- **AU–EU partnership targets AI for tackling health, food security, and sustainability** — The Brussels Times, 30 October 2026 AFRICA

  The AU and EU held an online high-level event on AI in science on 26 October 2026, the EEAS said. Participants named shared datasets, computing capacity and data governance as priorities. The European Commission said AU–EU research cooperation had supported about EUR 6 billion of activity. *Also under EU activities.*

- **Le Sénégal se dote d'un hub pour transformer les projets d'IA en applications concrètes** — wearetech.africa, 30 October 2026 SENEGAL

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- **INEC blames registration officers for AI-generated photos in voters' register** — Vanguard, 30 October 2026 NIGERIA

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ICT Industry

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Capacity

Training and skills

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Geopolitics

China activities

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  Summarised under AI.

EU activities

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.